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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump team to partially fund SNAP

Timing, amount of food benefits coming to recipients unclear

By Geoff Mulvihill and Kimberlee Kruesi
Associated Press

PROVIDENCE, R.I. — President Donald Trump's administration said Monday that it will partially fund SNAP after two judges issued

rulings requiring it to keep the nation's largest food aid program running.

The U.S. Department of Agriculture, which oversees the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, had planned to freeze payments starting Saturday because it said it could no longer keep funding it during the federal government shutdown.

The program serves about 1 in 8 Americans and is a major piece of the nation's social safety net.

It costs more than \$8 billion per month nationally. The government says an emergency fund that it will use has \$4.65 billion — enough to cover about half the normal monthly benefits.

Exhausting the fund potentially sets the stage for a similar situation in December if the shutdown isn't resolved by then.

It's not clear how much beneficiaries will receive, nor how quickly they will see value show up on the debit cards they use to buy

groceries. November payments have been delayed for millions of people.

"The Trump Administration has the means to fund this program in full, and their decision not to will leave millions of Americans hungry and waiting even longer for relief as government takes the additional steps needed to partially fund this program," Massachusetts Attorney General Andrea Joy Campbell, who led a coalition of Democratic state officials in one of

the lawsuits that forced the funding, said in a statement.

The administration also provided an infusion to the Special Supplemental Nutrition Program for Women, Infants, and Children, which helps low-income mothers buy nutritious staples. WIC received an additional \$450 million in funding, according to a senior administration official who spoke Monday on condi-

Turn to SNAP, Page 10

Bovino deposition nearly ground to halt

Government lawyers repeatedly objected, court records show

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

The deposition of Border Patrol Cmdr. Greg Bovino nearly ground to a halt last week as government lawyers repeatedly objected to questions by plaintiffs' attorneys, including some about communications between Bovino and White House adviser Stephen Miller, court records obtained by the Tribune show.

The impasse prompted attorneys for both sides to go before U.S. District Judge Sara Ellis in the middle of Bovino's sworn testimony on Thursday, where lawyers for the Justice Department complained that Bovino was being asked questions that were overbroad, poorly constructed and were not directly tied to the claims in the underlying lawsuit about the use of force by immigration agents during "Operation Midway Blitz."

During the hearing, Justice Department attorney Sarmad Khojasteh piqued the frustration of the judge by repeatedly interrupting her and fumbling over the facts of the case. Kosjasteh, who filed his first appearance in the case the day before Bovino's deposition, repeatedly referred to the Chicago immigration push as "Operation Midway Drift" and had to apologize for being new to the table.

"This is the problem when people come in, right, and

Turn to Bovino, Page 4

Aldermen force budget meeting

A group of Chicago aldermen scheduled a rare special City Council meeting in an effort to push Mayor Brandon Johnson to further consider budget cuts. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Garcia not running, source says

U.S. Rep. Jesús "Chuy" García of Chicago will not run for reelection, a source said, apparently ceding the spot to his chief of staff, who filed to run for the 4th Congressional District seat. **Page 2**

Bill strengthens ability to set vaccine guidelines

Lawmakers have passed a bill to strengthen Illinois' ability to make its own vaccine guidelines. **Business**



STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Family seeking answers

Dora Suane, sister of Ricardo Aguayo Rodriguez, talks with reporters Monday outside Loyola Medicine's Gottlieb Memorial Hospital in Melrose Park where her brother was hospitalized after being injured while being detained by federal agents in Melrose Park. Relatives said they don't know where he was taken after leaving the hospital. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



A muskrat sits on a floating piece of wood on April 12, 2021, in a retention pond in Concord at the Glen subdivision in Glenview. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Muskrats fight invasive cattails and help restore biodiversity, study finds

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

With their surgical nibbles, these large, semi-aquatic, buck-toothed rodents have emerged as crucial helpers for ecologists restoring degraded wetlands across the Great Lakes.

They are not the well-known, dam-building beavers but can often be found in the same marshy ecosystems. Muskrats —

which are more closely related to voles and hamsters — love to eat and build their lodges out of invasive cattails.

"One of the first things that happens is the cattail comes in, outcompetes the very diverse community of native plants," said Shane Lishawa, a researcher at Loyola University Chicago. "And that prevents not only plants, but the aquatic organisms — fish, invertebrates — and then

also birds and amphibians from accessing and utilizing these wetlands that are super critical for biodiversity support across the whole region."

Typha angustifolia, or narrow-leaf cattail, was introduced to North America in the dry ballast of European ships during the 19th century. Where it overlaps with the native broadleaf

Turn to Muskrats, Page 6

Hundreds gather to remember Baileys

Ceremony celebrated lives of four killed in helicopter crash

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

FLORA, Ill. — From across the state, several hundred mourners gathered Monday inside a cavernous gymnasium in rural southeastern Illinois to remember the son of Republican candidate for governor Darren Bailey, two of his grandchildren, and his daughter-in-law, all of whom were killed in a helicopter crash last month.

In what could have been a somber ceremony marked by sudden tragedy, the funeral for the four instead became a celebration of the victims, Zachary Bailey, his wife, Kelsey, and two of their children, 12-year-old Vada Rose and 7-year-old Samuel — lives that those at the event said were defined by grace and optimism guided by their devout Christian faith.

Speaking at the ceremony, Collin Moseley, a close friend of Darren Bailey, questioned whether "good morning" was an appropriate greeting for the audience before concluding

Turn to Bailey, Page 4

